

Technology News

Internet-savvy car

Rinspeed BamBoo is world's first Internet car that can read out your e-mails, Facebook and Twitter updates. It also helps motorists behind the wheel surf the Internet by using a series of voice commands.

Designed by audio and infotainment group Harman, this Internet-savvy car is compatible with all smartphones, iPads and Blackberry devices. It comes fitted with its own Wi-Fi transmitter, allowing occupants to use their laptops or mobile devices.

The car displays personal messages for the people in the vicinity of the car on an innovative 'Identiface' — a screen-based section which replaces the radiator grille. Identiface displays occupants' Facebook pages, news from around the world, the manufacturer's logo or an offer for a ride from A to B.

The custom-developed BamBoo-Community platform offers additional features centered on social networking, sustainability and optimal driving behaviour. The car also lets drivers search radio stations with voice com-

mands using its special infotainment technology.

Electricity conducting plastics

Until now plastic was known to be a good insulator of electricity, providing protection from electric shocks. An international team of scientists has now come up with plastics that can conduct electricity.

Researchers placed a thin film of metal on a plastic sheet and mixed it with the polymer surface using an ion beam. They found that the material was able to conduct electricity.

"What the team has been able to do here is use an ion beam to tune the properties of a plastic film so that it conducts electricity like the metals used in the electrical wires themselves, and even acts as a superconductor and passes electric current without resistance if cooled to low enough temperature," said Prof. Paul

Meredith, University of Queensland.

In order to verify conductivity, the team first created an electrical resistance thermometer and later a platinum resistance thermometer of industrial standard. When tested thoroughly, the material gave even better results, with comparable accuracy.

Solar-powered charging table

Now you can charge any mobile device supporting Qi technology wirelessly,



Panasonic solar-powered table

thanks to Panasonic's solar-powered table. And because it's solar-powered, you can save on electricity bills.

The table with a set of solar panels placed on the centre has a bunch of antennae that can transmit power to things like your phone wirelessly via the Qi wireless charging standard. The Qi standard is supported by about 60 manufacturers, which means that wireless charging stations are likely to be compatible with different brands in the future.

The table will be available in the market by late 2011 or early 2012.

Get rid of laptop charging bricks

A new technology developed by Transphorm, a Google-backed startup, could



Rinspeed BamBoo—an Internet-savvy car